U.S. Checks If TV Networks Broke Rules on Trump Coverage

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The U.S. **Justice Department** is looking into several big TV networks. It wants to know if they broke **competition laws** when they briefly stopped sharing White House "pool" coverage of President Trump.

In a **press pool**, a few reporters cover an event and share notes or video with many newsrooms. Last month, five networks paused that shared coverage for several days. They did this after the government took away press badges from reporters at CNN, MS Now, and Politico.

Officials asked ABC, CBS, CNN, NBC, and Fox News for messages about the pool. They said a group pause might break a law called the **Sherman Act**, which stops companies from unfairly limiting competition.

A department spokesperson said the team is only investigating. The networks have not commented yet, the report said. Earlier, a judge ordered White House access restored after the outlets sued. The **First Amendment** protects press freedom.

Word Treasure

Justice Department -- The part of the U.S. government that enforces federal laws.

press pool -- A few reporters who cover an event and share notes or video with many newsrooms.

competition laws -- Rules that stop companies from unfairly limiting rivals.

Sherman Act -- A U.S. law against unfair monopolistic business practices.

First Amendment -- The part of the Constitution that protects press freedom.

Background you need

A press pool is a small group of reporters who share White House coverage with many newsrooms.

Competition laws try to stop companies from working together in unfair ways.

The First Amendment protects freedom of the press in the United States.

Break it down

WHO: The U.S. Justice Department and major TV networks
WHAT: An investigation into a pause in shared White House pool coverage
WHERE: The United States, involving White House press access
WHY: Officials want to know if a group pause broke competition laws

Why it matters

Shared news coverage helps families learn what leaders are doing, so rules about the press matter to kids too.

Test what you remember

1. Who is investigating the TV networks?

- (A) The post office
- (B) A sports team
- (C) The Justice Department
- (D) A bakery

2. What is a press pool?

- (A) A list of songs
- (B) Reporters who share coverage with many newsrooms
- (C) A type of camera
- (D) A swimming pool

3. Which law did officials mention?

- (A) The Soccer Act
- (B) The Sherman Act
- (C) The Library Act
- (D) The Clean Plate Act

4. What did a judge do after the outlets sued?

- (A) Ordered access restored
- (B) Banned all news
- (C) Closed the White House forever
- (D) Fired the networks

5. Have the networks commented yet?

- (A) They moved to Mars
- (B) They closed all TVs
- (C) They have not commented yet
- (D) They said they won a race

6. What does the First Amendment protect here?

- (A) Press freedom
- (B) Secret sports scores
- (C) Free ice cream
- (D) Unlimited noise

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: B 4: A 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **Justice Department spokesperson: Says the team is investigating whether antitrust laws were broken.**
2. **Television networks: Have not commented yet, according to the report.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):